

Headers → Task 5

* Headers are additional bits of data you can send to the web servers when making requests.
* Although no headers are strictly required when making a HTTP request, you'll find difficult to view a website properly.

Common request Headers :-

(usually your browser)

These are headers that are sent from client, to the server.

Host :- Some web servers host multiple websites so by providing the host headers you can tell it which one you require, otherwise you'll just receive the default website for the server.

User-Agent :- This is your browser software and version number, telling web server your browser software helps it format the website properly for your browser and also some elements of HTML, javascript and CSS are only available in certain browsers.

Content-length :- when sending data to web server such as in form, the content length tells web server how much data to expect in web request. This way server can ensure it isn't missing any data.

Accept-Encoding :- Tells the web server what type of compression methods the browser supports so the data can be made similar for transmitting over the internet.

Cookie :- Data sent to server to help remember your information (see cookies task for more info).

Common Response Headers :-

These are headers that are returned to client from server after a request.

Set-Cookie :- Information to store which gets sent back to web server on each request.

Cache-Control :- How long to store content of response in browser's cache before it requests it again.

Content-type :- This tells client what type of data is being returned i.e. HTML, CSS, JS, Images, PDF, video etc. Using content-type header browser then knows how to process the data.

Content-Encoding :- what method has been used to compress the data to make it smaller.

When sending it over the Internet.

Quiz: -

1) What header tells the web server what browser is being used?

A) User-Agent

2) What header tells browser what type of data is being returned?

A) Content-Type

3) What header tells web server which website is being requested?

A) Host

Cookies - Task 6: -

* You've probably heard of cookies before small pieces of data that is stored on your computer.

* Cookies are saved when you receive "Set-Cookie" header from web server.

* Then every further request you make, you'll send a cookie data back to web server.

* Because HTTP is stateless cookies can be used to remind the web server who you are.

Cookies can be used in many purposes but most commonly used for website authentication. The cookies value would usually be a clear text string where you can see password, but a token.

Viewing your cookies: -

You can easily view what cookies your browser is sending to a website by using developer tools, in your browser. (chrome) : -> More tools -> Developer tools

MAC -> Safari -> Settings -> Advanced -> Show features for web developers ->

Developer -> Show web inspector.

* Once you open developer tool open, click on 'Network' tab. This tab will show list of all resources your browser has requested. You can click on each one

to receive a detail breakdown of request and response. If your browser sent a cookie, you will see them on "Cookies" tab of request.

Quiz:-

Q) Which header is used to save cookies to your computer?

A) Set-Cookie.